

Growing Together — Module 08: Planning — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. What would happen if we did not have clocks or calendars? (We would miss everything!).
2. What is the best thing about having a plan? (Less stress, more fun!).
3. What happens when a plan does not work out? (We update and try again!).
4. Why do we need to do some things before others? (Order matters — socks before shoes!).
5. What is your favorite thing to plan? (A birthday party? A trip? A playdate?).
6. How far into the future can you imagine? (Tomorrow? Next week? Next year?).
7. Why do routines help families feel calm? (Because everyone knows what to expect).
8. What is one routine your family has that you love?
9. What is the difference between a "Want" and a "Need" when planning? (Need: food. Want: ice cream).
10. If you could plan one perfect day for your family, what would it look like?

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Draw a "Comic Strip Schedule" of your morning routine. Show each step as a panel. Tape it to your door so the paper remembers for you!
2. Plan this weekend together as a family. On a big piece of paper, draw a timeline for Saturday and Sunday. Fill in the must-do and want-to-do activities.
3. Make a "Family Bucket List" — write down ten things your family wants to do together someday. Hang it up and check them off as you accomplish them.
4. Play the "What If?" game: "What if it rains on our picnic day? What is Plan B?" Practice making backup plans for three different scenarios.
5. Use a kitchen timer to plan a 15-minute cleaning sprint. How much can the whole family clean in 15 minutes? Planning makes action more powerful.

6. Create a "Visual Schedule" for bedtime using drawings or stickers. Include every step (bath, pajamas, teeth, story, lights out). Does following it make bedtime smoother?
7. Plan and cook a simple meal together. Write the steps first, gather ingredients, then follow the plan. How did planning ahead help?
8. Ask each family member: "What is one thing you are looking forward to?" Write the answers on a calendar. Having something to look forward to helps us plan through tough days.
9. Design a "Surprise Plan" for someone in the family (a secret note, a special breakfast, a hidden gift). Planning good surprises makes others happy and exercises your brain.
10. At bedtime, close your eyes and "time travel" to tomorrow. What do you see yourself doing? Tell a family member your plan. Planning is how we turn dreams into real days.